

★ SoundChain — How to Use

A plain-language guide to the SoundChain desktop apps · v0.1 beta

1. What you've got

SoundChain ships as real downloadable apps — files you own, not a website you visit. There are two kinds:

🌟 North Star (the sovereign node)

A peer-to-peer app with **no server behind it**. When you and friends open it on the same Wi-Fi, your apps find each other and share posts **directly** — no cloud, no account, no company in the middle. It even works with the internet unplugged.

🎵 The SoundChain apps (SoundChain · Lucy · Arena · Mint)

Desktop versions of the live SoundChain experience — the music platform, the Lucy AI, the Arena sports hub, and the Mint marketplace — in their own windows, with their own app icons.

2. Installing & opening

macOS (.dmg)

1. Double-click the `.dmg`, drag **SoundChain** into **Applications**.
2. First launch: **right-click the app → Open → Open**. (The beta isn't notarized yet, so macOS asks once. After that it opens normally.)

Windows (.exe)

1. Run the installer (or the `portable` .exe — no install needed).
2. If SmartScreen warns: **More info → Run anyway** (same beta-signing reason).

Linux (.AppImage)

1. Make it runnable: `chmod +x SoundChain*.AppImage`
2. Double-click it, or run it from the terminal.

Heads-up: the unsigned/beta warning on every OS is normal for a direct-download app and goes away once we add code-signing certificates. It does *not* mean the app is

unsafe.

3. Using North Star (the p2p node)

1. Open the app on **two or more machines on the same Wi-Fi**.
2. Watch the pill near the top: **● solo** turns into **● 2 peers · no server** when it finds the others — that's your private mesh forming.
3. Type in the box at the bottom and hit **Post** (or **Enter**).
4. Your post appears on **every** machine, instantly — with nothing in between.
5. Close and reopen — your posts are still there (saved locally on each device).

Try this: turn off Wi-Fi's internet (or pull the router's WAN cable) but stay on the same local network. Posts *still* sync. That's the whole point — the network is the people, not a data center.

4. Navigating the SoundChain apps

- **SoundChain** — your feed, profile/wall, music, and circle. Posts autoplay inline as you scroll.
- **Lucy** — your AI. Type to chat; she runs toward on-device intelligence.
- **Arena** — live sports takes, stats, picks and fantasy.
- **Mint** — the NFT/marketplace surface for creating and collecting.

Each app is its own window with its own icon, so you can keep them side-by-side like any other desktop apps.

5. Pricing & payment

Long-time **L1 + L2** members get the full app bundle **free**, as a thank-you. For everyone else it's a one-time **\$15** — a file you own, forever.

Pay your way

Pay in **USDC** (the anchor — exactly \$15, no volatility) · **BTC** · **ETH** · **SOL** · or **\$OGUN** (the native token, discounted). Prefer a card? A fiat on-ramp lets you pay in your local currency (USD, GBP, JPY...) and it settles automatically.

6. Your Pass & activation

Your purchase — or your L1/L2 status — is a **North Star Pass**: a token that lives in *your* wallet. It's the key, and it can't be revoked or switched off by anyone.

1. Open the app. If activation is enabled, you'll see the **Activate** screen.
2. **Step 1**: copy the message shown and sign it in your wallet — free, and it sends **no transaction**.
3. **Step 2**: paste the signature back. The app reads the chain directly to confirm your Pass — **no server, no account**.
4. Verified once, the device stays unlocked.

Why this way: the license is an asset you own, not a row in someone's database — the same spirit as the app itself: free, open, and yours.

SoundChain · Operation North Star · free, open, peer-to-peer. Questions? Open the **FAQ**. Built July 14, 2021 → today.